appears that President Biden is trying to help Netanyahu “use his head and not only his heart.” The arrival of US advisors in the country brings experience with urban fighting in Iraq, particularly in Fallujah and Mosul. But what use is technical expertise in the face of a complete lack of preparation in the army and ongoing chaos at all levels of government? Netanyahu, in today’s allocution, still spoke with certainty of the coming operation, the date of which will be decided by the war cabinet. As for his responsibility, he merely declared “that after the war, all will have to give answers,” he too. That can be called “drowning the fish” (*noyer le poisson*). How will this affect the country’s mood?

On October 7, the sudden Hamas attack was apparently accompanied by a near-total paralysis of Israel’s cyber network. This operation was so sophisticated that it was well beyond Hamas’s or even Iran’s capacity; only Russia may have such expertise. So much for Netanyahu’s “my friend Putin” … In short, wherever you look, you find traces of our PM’s lack of foresight: a failure far worse than what was imagined.

According to the *Wall Street Journal*, some 500 Hamas fighters were trained in Iran by the Quds Force in preparation to the October 7 attack. In any case, the Hamas operation seems to have been thoroughly planned for quite a long time. That it totally escaped our celebrated intelligence agencies is an incredible failure.

Qatar and Egypt have announced a breakthrough in hostage negotiations with Hamas. In Israel, this information is confirmed. Specific details should be revealed very soon.

The US has apparently requested a postponement of a ground operation in Gaza until sufficient antimissile defense systems have been installed at all American air force bases in the Middle East. In the past few days, about forty Americans have been wounded in bases in Iraq and Syria.

A friend of mine, an Israeli who teaches at an American university, was informed that his uncle had been killed in one of the kibbutzim overrun by